

SUPERSTORE SALES & PROFITABILITY STORY

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Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin	Quantity	Customers	Orders
\$2.30M	\$286.4K	12.47%	37,873	793	9,994

Central question: Where is growth creating value — and where is revenue hiding weak economics?

The dataset shows a \$2.30M retail business with \$286.4K profit. The headline is positive, but the portfolio mix matters: Technology generates 50.8% of profit, while Furniture generates 32.3% of sales but only 6.4% of profit.

1. Growth accelerated into 2017

Sales rose from \$484.2K in 2014 to \$733.2K in 2017 (+51.4%). 2017 was 20.4% above 2016.

Year	Sales	YoY
2014.0	\$484,247.50	
2015.0	\$470,532.51	-2.8%
2016.0	\$609,205.60	29.5%
2017.0	\$733,215.26	20.4%

So what? The growth trend is strong enough to support investment, but the next step should be to improve the mix of profitable growth.

2. Technology pays the bills; Furniture needs intervention

Category	Sales	Sales Share	Profit	Profit Share	Margin
Technology	\$836,154.03	36.4%	\$145,454.95	50.8%	17.4%
Furniture	\$741,999.80	32.3%	\$18,451.27	6.4%	2.5%
Office Supplies	\$719,047.03	31.3%	\$122,490.80	42.8%	17.0%

Finding: Furniture's 2.5% margin is dramatically below Technology's 17.4% and Office Supplies' 17.0%. Review Furniture pricing, discounting and sourcing by sub-category.

3. Regional performance needs a category lens

Region	Sales	Profit	Margin
West	\$725,457.82	\$108,418.45	14.9%
East	\$678,781.24	\$91,522.78	13.5%
Central	\$501,239.89	\$39,706.36	7.9%
South	\$391,721.91	\$46,749.43	11.9%

West leads in both sales and profit. The sharper finding is Central Furniture: –\$2.9K profit versus +\$11.5K in West Furniture. That points to a regional execution issue worth investigating before making a company-wide category decision.

4. Recommended 90-day action plan

Protect the profit engine — Keep Technology well-stocked and replicate West/East practices in weaker regions.

Fix Furniture economics — Audit Furniture by sub-category, discount band, supplier and region; prioritize Central.

Manage discounts by margin — Set approval thresholds for high-discount orders and track profit impact, not sales lift alone.

Build a weekly decision dashboard — Track Sales, Profit, Margin, Region, Category and Discount with drill-downs.

Decision principle: optimize for profitable growth — not revenue growth alone.

Source: Tableau Public Sample Data — Superstore Sales. The source describes Superstore as a fictitious retail dataset containing products, sales and profits for identifying areas of improvement.